

Hands-On with Intel Lunar Lake AI Laptops

We got our hands on laptops from ASUS, Acer, Lenovo, Dell, Samsung, MSI, and LG. The headline feature of these laptops is their incredible battery life. Intel showed benchmarks with over 20 hours of battery life on productivity tasks and claimed best-in-business

efficiency and integrated graphics performance compared to AMD and Qualcomm-powered laptops. While these comparisons are nothing new, we'll believe those claims after our comprehensive review and testing of the Lunar Lake laptops across our suite of

synthetic and real-world benchmarks. We'll then decide if Intel has truly regained its dominance in offering the best laptop SOCs. However, we did get our hands on some of the big Lunar Lake laptop launches at IFA 2024, and here are our initial impressions. Note that we weren't allowed to run benchmarks to test Lunar Lake performance at the launch events, so our impressions are based on laptop specifications and features. <https://bit.ly/4egUfaZ>

ASUS Zenbook S 14

The Zenbook S 14 is probably our pick of all the Intel Lunar Lake-based premium thin and light laptops revealed at IFA 2024. We like the design innovation that ASUS brings to the table with the Zenbook S 14. The "Ceraluminum" treatment (finish) on the ASUS

Zenbook S 14 is unique in many ways, from the use of materials to the feel and look it adds to the laptop. ASUS has attempted much-needed meaningful differentiation in material science, something the category desperately needs, as we start seeing very similar-looking and feeling (to touch) premium thin and light laptops that come across as generic metal slabs with little identity or character.



We tested and reviewed the ASUS Zenbook S 15 earlier in July 2024 and liked what we saw; the Zenbook 14 is essentially a 14-inch version of the Zenbook S 15, albeit with Intel Lunar Lake inside. The ASUS Zenbook 15 we tested was based on the AMD Ryzen AI 300 series processor. The most interesting

bit, though, is that if we take Intel's word, the ASUS Zenbook S 14 should be able to beat the ASUS Zenbook S 15 across every benchmark, be it gaming, battery life, AI performance, or even single-core CPU performance. And just for the record, the ASUS Zenbook S 15 is the fastest thin and light laptop we've tested so far at our test labs, so we can't wait to see if the Zenbook S 14 can take the crown away.

Samsung Galaxy Book 5 Pro 360

The first laptop from Samsung in the updated Galaxy Book 5 lineup is the Galaxy Book 5 Pro 360, a convertible (2-in-1) laptop with a 360-degree display that allows the laptop to be used in tablet mode for creator-centric workloads. The large 16-inch, 3K Dynamic AMOLED touch display can go up to 120Hz and claims 500 nits of peak brightness. We are fans of Samsung's latest Dynamic AMOLED 2X touch displays on laptops for their non-reflective treatment of the



displays, which surely fix one of the biggest issues we have with AMOLED displays – excessive reflections that impact viewability in brightly lit environments.

On the design front, we appreciate the Galaxy Book 5 Pro 360 for making the most of the 16-inch form factor while keeping the overall size and weight in check. The display has one of the slimmest bezels we've seen on a 16-inch laptop. Another area where the Book 5 Pro 360 stands out is the super-large touchpad, which has been optimized to prevent unintended activation during typing.